Debut

Plan it. Launch it. Grow it.

LEADER'S GUIDE FOR AGENCY OWNERS, TEAM LEADS AND MARKETING HEADS

Debut for Agencies and Teams

The leader's guide to running a group in one workspace: roles, approvals, workload and reporting.

Inside this guide

- Who can do what: owner, admin, lead, manager, creator, viewer
- Set up a team in a day and invite the right people
- The Team hub: see everyone's work, approvals and activity
- A private client portal: clients review, approve and comment
- Approvals, delegation, comments and notifications
- Agency operations: clients, freelancers, orders, invoices
- Security, playbooks and a leader's weekly routine

Version September 2026. Screens and limits described match Debut at the time of writing; the Pricing page always shows current pl

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1. Welcome: one workspace, one team, full visibility

Debut's group mode gives a team a single workspace with roles. People do their work in their own area; leaders see the whole picture, approve what goes out, balance workload and report to clients, without chasing updates on chat or spreadsheets.

What a leader gets	How
See everything the team is doing	**Team hub**: workload per person, overdue and unassigned tasks, what is publishing this week, recent activity. Plus the **Activity log** and global **Search**.
Control what goes live	**Approvals**: freelancers and junior staff send work to Review; only leads and managers approve or publish.
Delegate and follow up	Tasks with owners and due dates, **comments with @mentions**, in-app **notifications** and a **daily digest** email.
Run the agency business	**Content Ops**: clients, freelancer network, orders from brief to invoice, rate card, margins.
Give clients a private portal	Each client sees **only their own work**, approves or requests changes, and talks to you in one place. They never see other clients, budgets or your internal notes.
Report and stay in control	One-click monthly **Client report** (print to PDF or share a read-only link), full data **Export**, roles and audit trail.

Group mode is on the Team and Agency plans

Team: **5 seats**. Agency: **15 seats**. Clients get their own portal seats on top of that: **5 on Team, 25 on Agency**. New workspaces also get a 14-day trial with everything unlocked (5 seats, 5 client seats), so you can set up your team and a client before paying. Free and Starter have a single seat and no client portal.

2. Who can do what: the roles

Every person in your workspace has exactly one role. Choose the lowest role that lets them do their job. The Owner is the person who created the workspace and pays for it.

	Owner	Admin	Lead	Manager	Creator	Viewer
See marketing data	✓	✓	✓	✓	Own areas only	✓ (read-only)
Create and edit data	✓	✓	✓	✓	Own areas only	—
Approve and publish	✓	✓	✓	✓	—	—
Team hub and Activity log	✓	✓	✓	—	—	—
Invite, change and remove people	All roles below Owner	Lead, Manager, Creator, Viewer	Manager, Creator, Viewer	—	—	—
Export all data	✓	✓	✓	✓	—	—
Client prices and creator costs	✓	✓	✓	✓	—	✓
Billing and plan	Manage	View only	—	—	—	—
Industry, rename, API keys	✓	✓	—	—	—	—
Delete the workspace	✓	—	—	—	—	—

In plain words

- **Owner:** everything, including billing, plan changes, industry and deleting the workspace. There is one Owner per workspace.
- **Admin:** a co-runner. Everything except deleting the workspace or changing the subscription (they can view billing). Can manage leads and everyone below.
- **Lead (team lead):** sees and edits all marketing data, uses the Team hub, approves work, manages managers, creators and viewers, exports data and reads the activity log. **No access to billing or workspace settings.**
- **Manager:** full working access to marketing data and exports. Does not manage people and does not see the Team hub.
- **Creator (freelancers):** content items, Content Library, tasks, references, mood boards, the Calendar and the Idea Bank, plus Content Orders, **with prices and costs hidden**. They can move work to Review but the app will not let them approve or publish it.
- **Viewer:** read-only access to **everything on your plan**, including client lists and financials. Best for internal stakeholders.

- **Client (portal only):** outside clients. They see only the content and campaigns tagged with their client name, can approve or request changes and message you, and nothing else. Clients do not use up staff seats. See section 8.

Hierarchy rules that protect you

- You can only create, change or remove roles that are **strictly below your own**. A Lead cannot invite an Admin or another Lead; an Admin cannot create another Admin.
- Nobody can promote themselves, and nobody can demote or remove the Owner.
- Changing a role takes effect immediately on the person's next page load.

> **Do not give outside clients the Viewer role**
>
> The Viewer role sees **every module on the plan**: all clients, campaigns, invoices and creator costs. For outside clients use the **Client** role and the **client portal** (section 8), which shows each client only their own work.

3. Set up your team in one day

1. **Owner signs up.** Click **Start free**. Use your agency or team name as the workspace name. For **Your industry** pick **Agency / consultancy** (or the industry you mainly serve: D2C, FMCG, hospitality and so on) and keep **Load my industry starter kit** ticked.
2. **Verify email and turn on two-factor login** (Account > Set up two-factor). The Owner account controls billing and data: protect it first.
3. **Choose your plan** under **Plan** in the left menu (Owner or Admin). The trial gives you 5 seats and every feature for 14 days.
4. **Agree naming conventions** (see below), then **invite people** in this order: Admin(s), Leads, Managers, then Creators and Viewers. Go to **Team & roles > Invite someone**, enter the email and pick the role.
5. **Set up the shared foundations:** Brand Kit and Personas for your own agency, the **Clients** list (Content Ops), your first **Campaigns**, and first **Tasks** assigned by name. Type each client's name in the **Client** field of their content items and campaigns.
6. **Open the Team hub** (left menu, bottom). It should already show your members and their tasks.

How invitations work

- Each invite is an email with a link that is valid for **7 days**. The person must sign up (or log in) with **the same email address**; the address is locked so an invite cannot be hijacked.
- Pending invites appear under **Team & roles** with a **Revoke** button. **Pending invites use up seats** until accepted, revoked or expired.
- A person can belong to **several workspaces** (for example a freelancer working for two agencies). When they do, a workspace switcher appears at the top of their left menu.

Recommended roles by job title

Job	Role	Why
Agency founder / business owner	Owner	Pays, controls billing and data
Head of operations / co-founder	Admin	Runs the workspace day to day; can manage leads
Team lead, account lead, marketing head	Lead	Approves work, watches workload, manages the team, no billing
Strategist, content manager, social manager	Manager	Full working access without people management
Freelance writer, designer, video editor	Creator	Sees their work, cannot approve or see margins
Internal stakeholder, finance reviewer	Viewer	Read-only visibility
External client	Client (portal)	Sees only their own work; no other clients or money

The naming convention that makes the Team hub accurate

Debut matches the **Assignee** (tasks) and **Owner** (content items) fields to team members by their **full name or email**. The form suggests your team's names as you type: pick from the list. Agree that everyone sets their **Name** in Account > Profile exactly as it appears in your team (for example *Rohan Mehta*, not *Rohan* in one place and *R. Mehta* in another).

4. The leader's control room: the Team hub

Open Team hub from the left menu (Owner, Admin and Lead only). It answers four questions in one screen: Who is doing what? What is stuck? What needs my approval? What goes out this week?

Section	What it shows	What to do with it
Four tiles	Open tasks, Overdue, Awaiting approval, Publishing in 7 days	Your morning snapshot. A rising Overdue number means reprioritise.
Team workload	Per member: role, open tasks, overdue tasks, content in the pipeline, actions in the last 7 days, last login	Spot overload, idle capacity and people who have gone quiet. Rebalance by changing the Assignee on tasks.
Awaiting your approval	Content items in *Review* and content orders in *Editing* / *QA* or *Client review*	Open the item, then **Approve**, or **Send back** (content goes back to In progress; orders go to Revision).
Overdue tasks and Unassigned tasks	The ten most urgent of each	Assign or reschedule. Unassigned work is where deadlines slip.
Publishing in the next 7 days	Content with a publish date this week that is not yet Published	Confirm each piece is approved and has an owner.
Recent activity	The latest 15 actions by anyone	Click **Full activity log** for the latest 150.

More ways to see the team's data

- **Market Pulse** (Intelligence menu): live headlines from India and around the world, what people are searching for today, and mentions of the competitors you list under **Competitors** (tracked automatically). Owner, Admin, Lead and Manager can refresh it; everyone with access can read it. Team tracks up to 25 topics, Agency 50.
- **Activity log** (Owner, Admin, Lead): every create, update, delete, import, comment, invite, role change and login, with the person and time. Your audit trail.
- **Dashboard:** workspace-wide counts, this week's publishing, tasks due, campaign budget versus spend and lead funnel.
- **Search** (top of the left menu): finds a client, campaign, task or note across every module.
- **Board views:** most lists have a **Board view** (Tasks, Content Items, Campaigns, Leads, Content Orders and more) to drag work between statuses.
- **Calendar:** the whole team's content on one calendar, filterable by channel, with key dates, promotions and events overlaid.
- **Export data** (Owner, Admin, Lead, Manager): a ZIP of spreadsheets (CSV) of everything in the workspace. **Export CSV** on any list exports just that list.
- **Client report:** a monthly summary of KPIs, campaigns, content, leads, promotions and events, printable as PDF.

> **What the Team hub cannot know**
>
> Workload is counted from what people type in Assignee and Owner fields. If a task has no assignee, or the name does not match a member, it shows under **Unassigned** and is not counted against anyone. Make assigning a habit.

5. Approvals: nothing goes live without a leader

Content Items move through these statuses: **Idea, Planned, In progress, Review, Approved, Scheduled, Published** (or On hold). Content Orders (Content Ops) use: **Brief received, Assigned, In draft, Editing / QA, Client review, Revision, Approved, Delivered, Invoiced, Cancelled**.

1. A **Creator** or team member drafts an item and sets the status to **Review** (or, for orders, **Editing / QA** or **Client review**).
2. Debut sends an in-app **notification** to every Owner, Admin, Lead and Manager: *Priya sent for approval: Diwali teaser*. Leads also see it in the **Awaiting your approval** list on the Team hub and in their daily digest count.
3. A leader opens the item (click its title), reads it and any comments, then **approves** or **sends back** with a comment saying what to change (use **@Name**).
4. When approved, the person named in the item's **Owner** field is notified. After approval, a Lead or Manager moves it to **Scheduled** and **Published**.

The safeguard is built in

If a Creator tries to set **Approved, Scheduled or Published** on a content item (or **Approved, Delivered, Invoiced** on an order), Debut keeps it in review (**Review** for content, **Editing / QA** for orders) and tells them a lead or manager must approve. You do not have to police it.

Good approval habits

- Agree a target response time (for example: approvals cleared by 11:00 each weekday).
- Give feedback in **comments** on the item itself so it stays attached to the work.
- Ask creators to include the **Call to action**, **Hashtags** and **Asset / design link** before moving to Review.
- For client sign-off, use the **Client review** status on orders and share the deliverable link with the client outside Debut, or through the report link.

6. Delegating, comments and staying informed

Tasks: who does what by when

Growth > Tasks has Task, Description, **Assignee**, **Due** date, **Priority** (Low to Urgent), **Status** (Backlog, To do, In progress, Review, Done) and a link to the related campaign or plan. Use the **Board view** for stand-ups. Assigning a task to a member notifies them immediately.

Comments and @mentions

- Every record has a **Comments** box at the bottom of its edit page (content items, tasks, campaigns, orders and more).
- Type **@Full Name** or a unique **@FirstName** to notify that person. The record's assignee or owner is also notified of each comment.
- Authors can delete their own comments; Owners, Admins and Leads can delete any comment.
- Viewers can comment too, so stakeholders can leave feedback without editing data. Everyone can comment on any record they can open.

Notifications and the daily digest

- The **bell** (left menu, and top bar on mobile) shows unread notifications: assignments, mentions, comments on your items, items sent for approval and approvals.
- The **daily digest** is one email a day, sent only when something needs the person: overdue and upcoming tasks, content they own publishing in the next 3 days, and (for owners, admins and leads) how many items wait for approval. Everyone can turn it off under **Account**. It is sent by a scheduled job that your administrator has enabled.
- Ask everyone to install Debut on their phone (Android: Install app; iPhone: Add to Home Screen) so approvals can be handled on the move.

7. Running the agency: Content Ops

Content Ops is Debut's agency and marketplace toolkit (Team and Agency plans). It follows the real workflow: client, brief, match a creator, draft, QA, client review, delivery, invoice.

Clients

Content Ops > Clients stores Client / brand, Industry, Contact, Email, Phone, Plan / retainer, **Monthly value (₹)**, **Status** (Lead, Active, Paused, Churned) and Notes. Keep one row per client and enter the client name on every order and campaign so you can filter by it.

Freelancer network (Creator Network)

- Share your public **Creator apply form** (button on the **Ops Dashboard**). Applicants appear as **Applied**.
- Move each person through **Applied, Test sent, Vetted, Active** (or Paused / Blacklisted). Record skills, niches, languages, rate, turnaround, **test score** and **average rating**.
- Use the AI task *Creator screening test and rubric* to write a paid test, and *Editor QA of a draft* to review it.

Content Orders: from brief to invoice

1. **New order:** title, client, content type, brief, keywords, word count, tone, due date, **client price** and **creator cost**. (Use the AI task *Writer brief for a content order* to sharpen the brief.)
2. **Match a creator:** open the order and click **Match**. Debut lists Vetted and Active creators whose skills fit the content type (and language if you filter), sorted by rating and test score. Click **Assign**: the status moves from Brief received to Assigned.
3. **Production:** the creator drafts (In draft), sends to Editing / QA. Record **revision rounds** and a **quality score (1-10)**.
4. **Client review:** the deliverable link goes to the client. Feedback goes in the order's QA / client feedback field; use Revision when changes are needed.
5. **Approve, deliver, invoice:** Approved, Delivered, Invoiced. Add the delivery link. Raise the client invoice under **Invoices & Payouts**.

The Ops Dashboard: your margin at a glance

Content Ops > Ops Dashboard shows revenue and creator cost from approved, delivered and invoiced orders, the **margin**, the value of the open pipeline, overdue and unassigned orders, orders by status, a **creator leaderboard** (orders, completed, average quality, margin earned) and money still to collect or pay out.

Rate Card and Invoices & Payouts

- **Rate Card:** your service list with unit, price (₹), turnaround and what is included. Keep it current so quotes are consistent.
- **Invoices & Payouts:** track client invoices (in) and creator, influencer or vendor payouts (out) with amount, issue and due dates, status (Draft, Sent, Pending, Paid, Overdue) and notes for GST, TDS or UTR. Debut tracks money; it does not send invoices or move money.

- **Freelancers never see prices or costs.** Debut hides the client price and creator cost fields from the Creator role, so your margin stays private.

Market intelligence for pitches and client updates

- Add each client's category and rivals to the **Watchlist** (or as **Competitors**) so Market Pulse tracks them every week.
- Press **AI brief** for a cited summary you can turn into the weekly note to a client. It uses only the headlines shown and cites them by number.
- In **AI Studio**, *Live research: competitor intelligence* and *market & category scan* search the web and list their sources: ideal for new-business pitches. They cost 4 credits each (2 extra for the live search).
- Use **Add holidays** on Market Pulse to load public holidays into Key Dates before planning a client's calendar.
- Market Pulse reads public news and trend sources. It does not show a client's own social or ad account data; bring those numbers in by CSV or the API.

Promotions and Events

Promotions & Events (Team and Agency plans) plan online and offline promotions, contests, sampling, webinars and pop-ups. Events can auto-create a checklist of tasks with due dates counted back from the event date.

8. Working with clients: the client portal

Clients should be able to see their work, approve it and comment without seeing anyone else's. The Client role gives them exactly that: one private page, their own portal.

How it works

1. **Tag the work.** On each content item and campaign, fill the **Client** field with the client's name, spelled the same every time (for example *Grand Orchid Hotels*).
2. **Invite the client.** Go to **Team & roles > Invite someone**, choose the role **client**, enter their email and the **client name** exactly as used in step 1. They sign up from the emailed link (valid 7 days).
3. **Preview it yourself.** On the Team page click **Preview portal** beside the client (or open Client portal in the menu). You see exactly what they see. Only the client can approve.
4. **Send work for review.** When you move a content item to **Review**, the client is notified: *Ready for your review*. They open it from the portal.
5. **They decide. Approve** moves the item to Approved. **Request changes** (a note is required) sends it back to In progress. You are notified either way and the note appears on the item.
6. **Keep talking in one place.** Reply to the client from the item's **Comments** box and tick **Share with client**. Comments are **private to your team by default**.

The client sees	The client never sees
Their own content items: copy, call to action, hashtags, design link, publish date and a friendly status	Other clients' names, items or campaigns

The client sees	The client never sees
Their own campaigns: goal, channel, dates, status, KPI target	Budgets, spend, owners, learnings, notes
Messages you chose to share with them	Your internal comments, prices, creator costs, invoices, the Team hub, exports
Their notifications, help, and their account	Any other page in your workspace

Good to know

- **Clients do not use staff seats.** Team includes 5 client seats, Agency 25. Pending invites count. If you downgrade to a plan without the portal, clients see a short notice and no data.
- The portal shows **content items and campaigns**. It does not show KPI reports, invoices or file uploads. Send the monthly **Client report** PDF or read-only link for numbers.
- A client's role cannot be changed later: to change it, remove them and invite again.
- Clients can turn on two-factor login and set their name under their account, like anyone else.

Tip: make approvals a habit

Agree a response time with each client (for example *within 2 working days*). The Team hub shows how many items are waiting in Review, and clients get a notification the moment you move one there.

9. Reporting to leadership and clients

- **KPI Log:** have each channel owner log their KPIs weekly (Actual and Target). Analytics turns them into trend charts, campaign spend and the lead funnel.
- **Client report** (left menu): pick the month. It shows KPIs against target with progress bars, campaigns with budget and spend, content by channel, new leads by stage, promotions and events. **Print / save PDF** to send it.
- **Read-only share link** (Starter plan and above): a private link that opens the report without a login. Send it to a client for numbers (the portal covers their content and campaigns). Reset it any time under **Calendar > Reset link**: the old link stops working immediately (this also resets the calendar feed).
- **Weekly marketing report** (AI Studio): drafts a narrative from your KPI Log and campaigns for a leader's update.
- **Integrations:** push numbers in from Google Analytics, Meta or a spreadsheet through **CSV import** or, on Team and Agency, the **REST API** (with Zapier or Make). Debut does not connect to ad accounts directly yet.

A note about client data

The report link shows budgets and results for the whole workspace. If you serve several clients from one workspace, either keep one workspace per client for external sharing, or share reports only with people who may see all of it.

Make it look like yours

If clients see this workspace, go to **Account > Brand colours** (Owner or Admin) and set one hex colour for your company. It recolours the sidebar, buttons and highlights across the whole workspace, the client portal and printed reports — useful before a client meeting. Personal-brand workspaces don't have this option, and always stay on the default Debut lavender.

Mood boards for pitches and brand direction

Mood Boards (Content menu) is a freeform canvas, Miro-style: drag any note, image, colour or link card anywhere and resize it by its corner, useful for building a visual pitch with a client or creative team live on a call. A **Tidy up** button snaps everything back into a clean grid afterwards.

10. Security and governance for leaders

Area	What to do
Two-factor login	Ask **every** team member to turn it on (Account > Set up two-factor). It is per person; Debut cannot force it, so make it your team policy. Owners and admins first.
Joiners and leavers	Invite by work email. When someone leaves, remove them the same day under **Team & roles > Remove**. They lose access immediately.
Least privilege	Give the lowest role that works. Use Creator for freelancers and keep Viewers internal.
Audit trail	Review the **Activity log** weekly. It shows who created, changed, deleted, exported or invited, with times.
Data ownership	**Export data** monthly as a backup. Owners can permanently delete the workspace under Account > Danger zone.
Links and keys	Reset the calendar/report link and the webhook URL if they were shared widely. API keys (Owner, Admin) are shown once and can be revoked; use read-only keys where possible.
Support access	Authorised Debut staff can open a read-only view of your workspace only to help with support. Every use is written to your Activity log.
Ownership	The Owner can hand the workspace to an Admin, Lead or Manager under **Account > Transfer ownership** (needs password, a two-factor code if enabled, and typing TRANSFER). The old owner becomes an Admin and the new owner is emailed. Review billing afterwards.

11. Playbooks

Onboard a new client (30 minutes)

- [ ] Add the client under Content Ops > Clients with retainer, monthly value and status Active.
- [ ] Write the client name once, then use it everywhere in the **Client** field of their content items and campaigns.
- [ ] Invite the client to the **client portal** (role client) and check it with **Preview portal**.
- [ ] Create their first **Campaign** (objective, channel, budget, KPI target, brief) and **Persona**.
- [ ] Record their brand rules in **Brand Kit** (voice, colours, do and don't).
- [ ] Create a task list from the **Launch Checklist** and assign each task by name.
- [ ] Set up the first month's content in the **Calendar** and mark the approval owner on each item.
- [ ] Agree the reporting date and share the read-only report link (or schedule a PDF) for month-end.

Onboard a freelancer

- [ ] Invite as **Creator**, or ask them to use the apply form if they are new.
- [ ] Move them to **Test sent**, then **Vetted** after the test; record test score and rate.
- [ ] Assign a small first order. Rate quality (1-10) and set status to **Active** if it goes well.
- [ ] Remind them: set status to **Review** when done; leads approve. They will not see prices.

Content production pipeline (per piece)

Stage	Owner	Debut status
Brief and idea	Strategist / Manager	Idea, Planned
Draft	Creator	In progress
Internal review and approval	Lead / Manager	Review, Approved
Scheduling	Manager	Scheduled
Published and logged	Manager	Published (then log KPIs)

The leader's weekly routine

When	Time	In Debut
Every morning	10 min	Read Notifications. Open the **Team hub**: clear approvals, assign unassigned tasks, look at Overdue and 'Publishing in 7 days'.
Monday planning	30 min	Review the Calendar and campaign board with the team. Assign the week's work by name. Check Content Ops pipeline and overdue orders.
Friday wrap-up	20 min	Check workload (Team hub), have channel owners log KPIs, scan the Activity log, note wins for the client update.
Month end	60 min	Open the **Client report** per client, review Ops Dashboard margin and creator leaderboard, raise invoices and payouts, export data, plan next month.

12. Questions and fixes

Problem	What to do
The Team hub shows no tasks for someone.	Their name in **Assignee** does not match their account name or email. Pick names from the suggestion list and ask everyone to set their exact name in Account > Profile.
I cannot invite more people.	You have reached the plan's seat limit (Team 5, Agency 15), and pending invites count. Revoke an unused invite, remove a member, or upgrade.
A member sees 'more members than the plan allows'.	The workspace has more members than the current plan's seats (for example after a downgrade). Only the Owner is exempt. The Owner should upgrade or remove members.
A creator says they cannot publish.	By design: creators send work to Review and a lead approves. Approve it from the Team hub.
A lead cannot see Billing.	By design. Leads run the team; Owner and Admin handle billing.
A freelancer asks about prices.	They cannot see them; Debut hides the client price and creator cost fields from the Creator role.
Can a client log in and see their own work?	Yes: invite them with the **client** role and their client name (Team and Agency plans). They see only work tagged with that name. Never use the Viewer role for outside clients.
The client says they see nothing.	Their client name on the invite does not match the **Client** field on your items (spelling counts, upper or lower case does not). Fix either one, then use Preview portal to check.
Can I move the Owner role to someone else?	Yes: Account > Transfer ownership (Owner only).
An invite says expired or invalid.	Invites last 7 days and must be opened with the invited email. Revoke and send a new one from Team & roles.
Who can turn off a person's two-factor if they lose their phone?	They use a recovery code. If none, contact support so an administrator can reset it.
How do I see everything one person did?	Open the Activity log (it lists the person for each action) or search for their name in Team hub workload and the record lists.

Need help?

Open **Help & guides** in the menu, or use **Send feedback** (it includes the page you were on). You can also use **Contact** in the page footer.